



Low-end Intel CPUs will increase

Intel to increase the production of low-end CPUs since they no longer have a shortage of small-core microprocessors. <https://digit.in/aug19-67>



Vivo Z1Pro

The selfie camera on this phone is marketed as an 'in-display' camera, but it's just a glorified cutout. <https://digit.in/aug19-68>

OnePlus 7

A barebones flagship that covers the basics the best

OnePlus is a changed company with one foot on the premium side while one is in the budget flagship side. Does this bode unwell for OnePlus fans? Let's find out.

Design and Display

The OnePlus 7 is built out of glass, but feels pretty solid. There's Gorilla Glass 5 on the back and Gorilla Glass 6 on the front. There's a screen-protector built-in to the display that got scratched easily and the mirror red finish that we received for review looks pretty swell. The OnePlus 7 is quite identical to the OnePlus 6T. What's changed is the gigantic bump around the camera module that makes the phone wobble when on a flat surface.

Dual stereo speakers have made their way to the OnePlus 7. There's also an in-display fingerprint sensor that's visibly fast and accurate. However, face unlock works faster. It has a 6.41-inch AMOLED panel with a waterdrop notch. It's FHD+ instead of QHD+ and the screen refresh rate is 60Hz. The OnePlus 7's HDR rated display is bright and vibrant.

Performance and battery

The Snapdragon 855 SoC is coupled with up to 8GB RAM and 256GB storage. There's no question of the phone slowing down anytime soon. The components OnePlus has used in this are the same as the Pro variant, save for the lack of a 12GB RAM variant. As a result, the performance of the phone is one of the best on an Android device. Credit should be given to OxygenOS that's based on Android 9 Pie and brings onboard interesting optimisations.

Benchmark analysis reveals the OnePlus 7 is just as fast as its sibling and even ahead in some cases.

The 3,700mAh battery on the OnePlus 7 is the same as its predecessor.



But while the capacity is the same, there is a slight increase in the screen-on time, thanks to the 7nm efficiency. On Geekbench Battery Test, it took around 10 hours 15 minutes to drain the battery while 15 minutes of PUBG Mobile drained the battery by around 5 percent. On the other hand, 30 minutes of Netflix (with HDR on) drained 7 percent battery. These are decent numbers and in line with most other Snapdragon 855-powered phones.

Camera

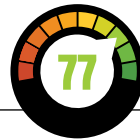
It's clear the OnePlus 7 Pro was what the company was more focused on, while the OnePlus 7 camera comes off as an afterthought. The OnePlus 7 has a 48MP primary sensor paired with a 5MP depth sensor. By default, you are restricted to shooting either the regular wide-angle photos or portrait shots with blurred backgrounds. There is 2X zoom, but that's digitally acquired and doesn't offer the same quality as optical zoom.

As for the images themselves, they carry the typical OnePlus look. Neutral

colours, excellent HDR performance, and now extra sharpness thanks to the pixel binning that the camera performs by default every time it takes a photo. As such, the OnePlus 7 camera is pretty reliable in taking landscape photos, but struggles to take close-up shots. The AF system in the 48MP sensor has difficulty locking focus. There's OIS in the camera which helps take a stable shot when zoomed in, but it particularly helps while shooting videos.

Then there's the portrait mode. It works well in objects that are near the camera. Objects that are a little further away has inconsistent subject separation which is ironic considering the only use of the secondary 5MP depth sensor is to get better depth of field.

There's also the nightscape mode which works pretty well, but not without its own flaws. For one, it takes a long time to shoot the image irrespective of the amount of light available. As such, the OnePlus 7's rear camera stack is reliable, but not exciting. Around the price of the OnePlus 7, you have phones that come fitted with a wide-angle camera, and paying a little extra will get you a telephoto lens as well.



FEATURE	68
PERFORMANCE	85
DESIGN	70
VALUE FOR MONEY	76

OnePlus 7 Verdict

The OnePlus 7 is the budget flagship OnePlus was known for before they got into the very segment they intended to kill. While the OnePlus 7 Pro breaches the Rs 50,000 mark, the OnePlus 7 starts at a price lower than what the OnePlus 6T did. For a lesser price, you not only get the same raw performance as the OnePlus 7 Pro, but also an HDR display and a sturdy build. If OnePlus is your brand of choice and spending over Rs 50,000 is out of the question, the OnePlus 7 is the phone to get.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.41-inch (1080x2340) | PROCESSOR: Qualcomm Snapdragon 855 | FRONT CAMERA: 16MP | REAR CAMERA: 48MP + 5MP | RAM: 6GB | STORAGE: 128GB | BATTERY CAPACITY: 3700mAh | OS: Android 9 Pie

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